



WhatsApp Communities

WhatsApp is adding a new section called "Community Home" to help users manage their groups. <https://digit.in/sep22-53>



PS VR2 coming early 2023

Sony has finally announced the PlayStation VR2 launch will take place in early 2023. <https://digit.in/sep22-54>

Realme Buds Air 3 Neo Overshadowed by its brethren

Realme is at the top of its game in the budget audio segment, launching product after product – all with modest price tags and eye-catching features. The Realme Buds Air 3 Neo, priced at ₹1,999, are the company's latest budget entrant. It competes against similarly-priced earphones from Oppo, OnePlus, Xiaomi, and Realme itself. Will these earbuds impress? Let's find out.

BUILD AND FIT

The Realme Buds Air 3 Neo sport an in-ear design with protruding stems. The back of the stems double as capacitive touch sensors. The touch controls work reliably and misreadings are few and far between. The case comes with a half-translucent design. The translucent lid certainly gives it a unique look.

The case is exceptionally slim and compact, so it will easily slip into small handbags and pockets. The case's hinge is reinforced with metal, so it feels sturdy enough, but the plastic lid does feel slightly flimsy.

The earbuds have a matte finish and are white all over except for the back of the stems which possess a glossy silver finish. It does look a bit ostentatious, in our opinion, but the young target audience may like the look. The buds fit exceptionally well and can be used during activities such as gymming, running, or jogging. Weighing merely 4g each, we found the earbuds to be pretty comfortable to wear as well. The buds are also IPX5 water resistant.

FEATURES

For the price of ₹1,999, the Realme Buds Air 3 Neo is brimming with features. The buds are Dolby Atmos-enabled and provide a decent immersive audio experience. They don't have the widest soundstage, so the experience won't be exceptional though. The earbuds are also compatible with Realme's excellent accompanying app – Realme Link. The



app gets you access to some nifty features such as Game Mode, Volume Enhancer Mode, customisable controls, and EQ presets.

You can customise the earbud controls as you wish. You can even set an action for volume controls, something that audio manufacturers usually skip out on. The earbuds also come packing other features such as instant connection, IPX5 water resistance, and Bluetooth v5.2 connectivity. At ₹2K, these are feature-packed earphones but Realme seems to be competing with itself here since the Realme Q2 earphones can now be purchased at the same price of ₹1,999 on e-commerce platforms, but they come packing extra features such as Active Noise Cancellation and Transparency Mode as well.

PERFORMANCE

Equipped with 10mm dynamic drivers and a PEEK + TPU composite diaphragm, the Realme Buds Air 3 Neo has a bass-boosted sound profile that bass-lovers will appreciate. But on the default Bass Boost+ EQ setting, it can sound quite muddy. To combat this, you can choose the Balanced EQ preset within the app which applies a more agreeable sound signature. The result

is still bass-biased, but it does dampen the rattling, muddy bass effect. We found that the mids, by themselves, are depicted pretty accurately with clear vocals and detailed-sounding instruments. In *Hello* by *Adele*, you can hear the small breaths she takes between sentences with the Balanced or Bright EQ preset. The highs are well-produced up to the 8 kHz mark, closely following our in-house curve. The bump in the 3 kHz – 4 kHz mark does cause some unwanted sibilance that can sound a bit unpleasant at times. However, we're still impressed by the highs from the buds at this price point.

As for the microphone performance, it is quite lacklustre. Your voice can sound muffled and ambient sounds get picked up easily.



BUILD	71
FEATURES	65
PERFORMANCE	68
VALUE	75

BATTERY LIFE

Battery life worries are a non-issue with the Realme Buds Air 3 Neo. In our tests, the earbuds surpassed their rated battery life and lasted a little over 7 hours at 70 per cent

volume. The charging case provided another 3 charges with juice left to spare. The buds support fast charging, so just 10 minutes of charge time provides a whopping 2 hours of playtime.

VERDICT

The Realme Buds Air 3 Neo are a pretty sweet deal equipped with a plethora of features for its relatively inexpensive price. Add to that, excellent battery life, a decent build, and a comfortable fit. However, Realme's own Buds Q2 is a better deal at just ₹200 more since they come with slightly better sound and extra features such as ANC.

– Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

DRIVER: 10 mm dynamic | BLUETOOTH VERSION: 5.2 | AUDIO CODECS: SBC, AAC | WIRELESS RANGE: Up to 33 feet | BATTERY LIFE (BUDS): 7 hours | BATTERY LIFE (BUDS + CASE): 30 hours | CHARGING TIME: 60 minutes (buds), 120 minutes (buds + case) | COLOURS: Galaxy White, Starry Blue

CONTACT

REALME | PHONE: NA | EMAIL: service@realme.com | WEBSITE: <https://www.realme.com/in/>